e.g. settlements found in the Himalayas, the Alps, the Rockies.

The **rectangular settlements** are almost straight, meeting each other at right angles. Such a settlement is found in plain areas (or) inter montane plain. E.g., settlements found in Sutlej. Houses built around a central area are known as **Circular pattern of settlements.** Such settlement develop around lakes and tanks. The **Star like pattern of settlement** develops on the sites and places where several roads converge and houses spread out along the sides of roads in all directions. e.g. The Namakkal urban settlements



Star like pattern



Circular pattern



Pilgrim settlement may come up around a place of worship(or) any spot with a religious significance. E.g. settlements in Palani Hills, Tamil Nadu.

Wet Point Settlement

A wet point settlement is located near water sources in arid regions.



Dry Point Settlement

A dry Point settlement is located in low-lying areas in the regions of excessive dampness. Dry point settlements are not affected by flood or any other source of water. Such settlements are found in the coastal plains of Kerala and deltas along the east coast of India.

Urban Settlements

The settlements in which most of the people one engaged in secondary and tertiary activities are known as urban settlements. Town, cities, and the areas of large cities are referred to as urban areas.

Classification of Urban Settlements

The definition of urban area varies from are country to another. Some of the common basis of classification are

- Size of population
- Occupational structure
- Administration

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Town

Town is a general name for an urban place, usually a settlement meeting a prescribed minimum population threshold. The settlement with a population more than 5000 people is called a town. Basis on the function cities can be classified into towns, such as administrative, cantonment, academic etc.,

City

The term City is generally applied to large urban places with a central business district. In India an urban place with more than one lakh population is considered as a city .

Mega city

A mega city is a very large city typically with a population of more than 10 million people.

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